



FRANCE

Capital city: Paris**Area:** 211,208 sq miles
(547,030 sq km)**Population:** 60,100,000**Official language:** French**Major religions:** Christian
90%, Muslim 8%,
Buddhist 1%, Jewish 1%**Government:** Multiparty
democracy**Currency:** Euro**Adult literacy rate:** 99%**Life expectancy:** 79 years**People per doctor:** 303**Televisions:** 601 per 1,000
people

MONACO

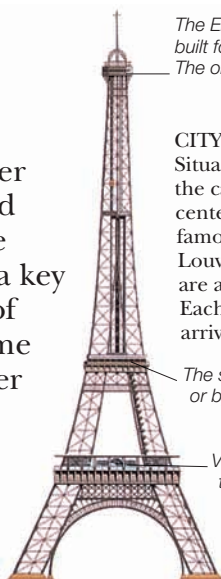
Capital city: Monaco**Area:** 0.75 sq miles
(1.95 sq km)**Population:** 32,130**Official language:** French**Major religions:** Christian
95%, other 5%**Government:** Monarchy**Currency:** Euro**Adult literacy rate:** 99%**Life expectancy:** 79 years**People per doctor:** 152**Televisions:** 768 per 1,000
people

ANDORRA

Capital city: Andorra la
Vella**Area:** 181 sq miles
(468 sq km)**Population:** 69,150**Official language:** Catalan**Major religions:** Christian
94%, other 6%**Government:** Multiparty
democracy**Currency:** Euro**Adult literacy rate:** 99%**Life expectancy:**
83 years**People per doctor:** 385**Televisions:** 391 per 1,000
people

FRANCE

THE INFLUENCE OF French culture, fashion, and food can be seen all over the world. As a leading industrialized nation and founding member of the European Union, France also plays a key role in world affairs. Since the end of World War II, the country has become Europe's major agricultural producer and exporter, with main crops of wheat, sugar beets, sunflower seeds, apples, and grapes used for wine. France boasts the world's fastest train, the TGV, which can travel at speeds up to 320 mph (515 km/h).



The Eiffel Tower is 984 ft (300 m) high and was built for the Paris World Exposition of 1889. The observation gallery can hold 800 people.

CITY OF CULTURE

Situated on the banks of the Seine River, Paris is the capital of France and its cultural and political center. One of the world's most visited cities, its famous landmarks include the Eiffel Tower, the Louvre, and the cathedral of Notre Dame. There are also many museums, shops, and restaurants. Each spring, the world's leading fashion designers arrive in Paris to present their latest collections.

The second level is reached by elevator or by climbing another 700 steps.

Visitors reach the first level by elevator or by climbing up 360 steps.



VILLAGE LIFE

Although many French people have moved from the countryside to live in the cities, village life is still important. Throughout France villages have kept a strong identity, with local festivals, fairs, and weekly food markets. Life centers around the village square, where people often gather to play *boules*, the national game of France.

INDUSTRY

One of the world's leading industrial nations, France has large manufacturing, steel, and chemical industries and competes at the forefront of engineering and technology. The country is a major producer of cars and aircraft, such as this Airbus in its Toulouse factory. France has a large nuclear industry that generates over 75 percent of the country's electrical power. With millions of visitors a year, tourism is also important to the economy.

FOODS OF FRANCE

France has such a range of climates and landscapes that it can produce many different types of food and fine wines. Each region has its own special dish. Central France, for example, is famous for boeuf bourguignon (beef in red wine), while Marseille on the Mediterranean coast specializes in bouillabaisse (fish soup with garlic). France is also known for its breads and pastries, such as croissants, and different types of cheeses.

Crottins de
Chavignol cheese

Croissant

Garlic

French people relax
with friends in a
café or restaurant.



Oil from lavender is an important ingredient in many perfumes, as well as in soaps and bath oils.

A FINE FRAGRANCE

Some of the world's finest perfumes come from France. Most perfume is made in Grasse in southern France where fields of lavender, roses, and jasmine are grown. Their essential oils are extracted and blended to make a variety of scents. As many as 300 oils may be used in one perfume.

